# Chain of Custody

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## Feature: Sample Splitting and Custody Tracking

As an Analyst or Handler

I want to split samples and move custody with clear records

So that data errors stop through an unchangeable digital audit log

### Rule: Sample portions must inherit parent identity, and custody logs must be immutable

#### Scenario: Creating a child sample fraction for external referral testing

Given an environmental water sample exists in the system with an active status of "Accepted"

When an Analyst runs a split command to make a sub sample fraction for an external test

Then the system must automatically link the parent sample reference ID to the new fraction

And set the external referral flag to true

#### Scenario: Appending a secure transaction block to the custody log during internal routing

Given a sample with an active laboratory reference ID moves to a new testing station

When the operator updates the internal location to "Station B" and enters a valid bench sheet reference

Then the system must automatically log the staff identifier and the current timestamp

And block all standard tries to change or delete this custody log row